



Kickstarter Acquisitions

The first Kickstarter acquisition occurs that too of a dying company Drip as both support to raise funding but for different causes. <http://dgit.in/KickAcquire>

PR learns

Working with startups is a nightmare if you are not familiar with chaos but here are 3 simple steps to tackle it straight from the horse's mouth. <http://dgit.in/PRLearn>

Origins

radio's limitations by modulating the frequency of the transmitted signal, giving rise to the FM radio technology that would eventually revolutionize the radio industry.

What RCA had asked him to work on was a way to filter out static. What he had invented was something that was a direct competition to RCA's existing infrastructure and business. As a result, RCA had delayed further research into the same. Meanwhile, Armstrong was granted a patent for FM radio in 1933 and had performed successful demonstration after demonstration that showcased the never-heard before clarity that FM brought to radio broadcasts.

Knowing the potential of this technology, Armstrong took it to other players in the market like Zenith and General Electric. He also heavily lobbied the Federal Communications Commission (FCC) to create an FM broadcast spectrum between 42-50MHz and himself invested in creating a small but high-powered network of FM radio stations to truly broadcast the superiority and promote the adoption of FM. But the RCA had other outcomes planned for FM.

RCA had hired a former head of the FCC before the second world war broke out to deter the spread and adoption of FM. Although their pre-war efforts were largely unsuccessful, during the war the nation was largely preoccupied with other matters and it was no surprise that when the war ended, the FCC came out with a number of regulations that effectively crippled FM. Citing flimsy reasons and unreasonable potential technological problems, FM was forced to move to a higher band, which rendered the existing FM stations and devices useless. Regardless to say, the public, once burned with their now useless FM radios, was further hesitant to get new devices for the new bands and the arrival and propagation of television sealed FM's fate. After a number of drawn out expensive lawsuits, Armstrong ended his own life. Proprietary interests had completely obliterated the good intentions of a true innovator.

One of the earliest instances of copyright laws was the adoption of the first copyright act by the British Parliament. Known as the Statute of Anne, the law stated that the copyright of any author over



Edwin Armstrong was one of the first victims of a major corporation misusing laws in the spirit of DRM

their own book was valid only for 14 years, and had to be renewed after that if the author was alive. And this law was much less powerful than the ones we are familiar with now - it did not restrict adaptations, translations and derivative works of any kind. At that point of time, copying and piracy was not a major concern mainly because copying and publishing was an expensive thing to do and was only handled by major publications.

Forget your peers

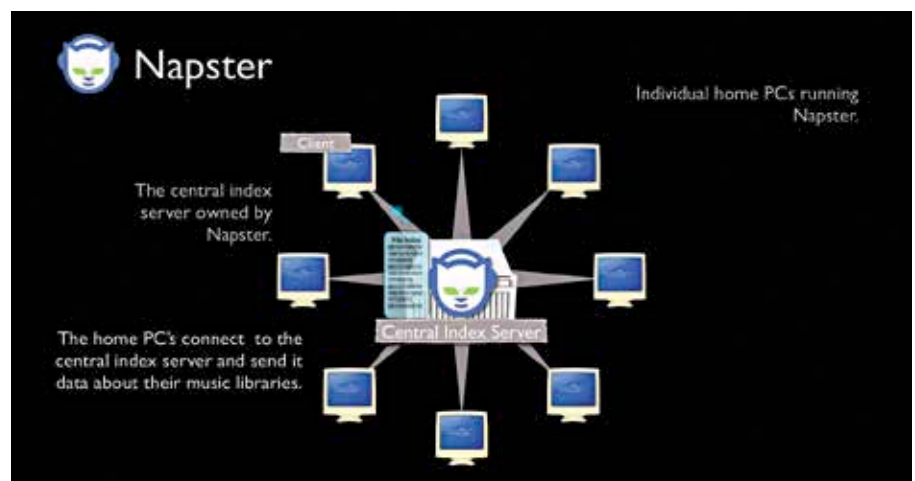
Fast forward to the present day - the internet has become the universally accepted medium for exchange of information of any kind. And as a result,

it is much easier to violate copyright now than it has ever been. The basic nature of digital information entails that any kind of digital information can be copied now with highly easy-to-use methods and often require no expertise of any kind in the field of work that the original information deals with. As a result, there are DRM regulatory technologies that are sometimes strict enough to inconvenience genuine users.

Since the advent of internet, a new form of file sharing had emerged - peer to peer (p2p) file sharing. Even though the technology might have evolved over time, the basic principle is still the same - having access to files in a network of connected computers connected via a central server at a large scale. Even though the technology of file-sharing was in place for a while, it was truly popularised at the turn of the century by Napster.

Napster was started by the then 15 year old Shawn Fanning in his university first year as a network that allowed connected users to download compressed digital music files, especially MP3, from any machine on the network. What popularised it compared to other p2p services is that Napster used its central server to index the music on connected users' machines and made the data searchable across their network. And what popularised it even more was the landmark lawsuit that went on to set a standard regarding intellectual property: A&M Records, Inc. v. Napster, Inc.

In course of the lawsuit, Napster cited many defences (inability to differentiate



Napster worked by indexing the connected computers using a centralised server